

SITUATIONS, HONEST REPLIES ONLY!



You have an assignment due tomorrow → *Watch Netflix **or** start working?*



You want to study → *Cook a snack first **or** start studying?*



Deadline is tonight → *Panic Monster wakes up **or** keep relaxing?*



You need to wake up early tomorrow → *Watch “one more” video **or** go to bed on time?*



Your room is messy → *Clean it “later” **or** clean it now?*

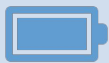
SITUATIONS, HONEST REPLIES ONLY!



You plan to read for 30 minutes → *Start reading **or** rearrange your bookshelf instead?*



You promised yourself to write your report today → *Actually write it **or** “research” memes for an hour?*



Your laptop battery is at 5%.→ *Plug it in **or** continue working while praying like it’s a survival movie?*



Your friend asks if you started your project.→ *Admit the truth **or** say “I’ll start in 5 minutes” (the universal lie)?*

INSIDE THE MIND OF A MASTER PROCRASTINATOR

ACTIVE LISTENING



BEFORE YOU WATCH

CHECK THE MEANING OF THE FOLLOWING PHRASES:

Thesis	Why we are the way we are	Advanced civilization
Spread the work out	Rational decision-maker	Well-earned leisure time
Things stay civil	Instant Gratification	For the sake of
Bump it up	Room on the schedule	Guardian angel
Kick it up	Lives entirely in the present moment	Public embarrassment
High gear	Memory of the past	Scary consequence
They came and went,	Knowledge of the future	System's in mayhem
Perplexed	Keep well-slept	Insane behavior
Epiphany	Tribal times	Intense frustration

WHILE LISTENING

Read the tasks in the worksheet and complete it while listening.

WHILE LISTENING - ANSWERS

But then came my 90-page senior [thesis](#), a paper you're supposed to spend a year on. And I knew for a paper like that, my normal [workflow](#) was not an option. It was way too big a project. So I planned things out, and I decided I kind of had to go something like this. This is how the year would go. So I'd start off [light](#), and I'd [bump it](#) up in the middle months, and then at the end, I would kick it up into [high gear](#) just like a little [staircase](#). How hard could it be to walk up the stairs? No big deal, right?

WHILE LISTENING - ANSWERS

But then those middle months actually went by, and I didn't really write words, and so we were here. And then two months turned into one month, which turned into two weeks. And one day I woke up with three days until the deadline, still not having written a word, and so I did the only thing I could: I wrote 90 pages over 72 hours, pulling not one but two all-nighters -- humans are not supposed to pull two all-nighters -- sprinted across campus, dove in slow motion, and got it in just at the deadline.

WHILE LISTENING - ANSWERS

No, no, it was very, very bad. Anyway, today I'm a [writer-blogger](#) guy. I write the blog Wait But Why. And a couple of years ago, I decided to write about [procrastination](#). My behavior has always [perplexed](#) the non-procrastinators around me, and I wanted to explain to the non-procrastinators of the world what goes on in the [heads](#) of procrastinators, and why we are the way we are. Now, I had a hypothesis that the brains of procrastinators were actually different than the [brains](#) of other people. And to test this, I found an [MRI](#) lab that actually let me scan both my brain and the brain of a proven non-procrastinator, so I could compare them. I actually brought them here to show you today. I want you to take a [look carefully](#) to see if you can notice a difference. I know that if you're not a trained brain expert, it's not that obvious, but just take a look, OK? So here's the brain of a [non-procrastinator](#).

WHILE LISTENING - ANSWERS

And to the Monkey, humans are just another [animal species](#). You have to keep [well-slept](#), well-fed and propagating into the next generation, which in [tribal times](#) might have worked OK. But, if you haven't noticed, now we're not in tribal times. We're in an [advanced civilization](#), and the Monkey does not know what that is. Which is why we have another guy in our brain, the [Rational Decision-Maker](#), who gives us the ability to do things no other animal can do. We can [visualize](#) the future. We can see the big picture. We can make long-term plans. And he wants to take all of that into account. And he wants to just have us do whatever [makes sense](#) to be doing right now.

WHILE LISTENING - ANSWERS

Now, sometimes it makes sense to be doing things that are easy and fun, like when you're having dinner or going to bed or enjoying well-earned leisure time. That's why there's an overlap. Sometimes they agree. But other times, it makes much more sense to be doing things that are harder and less pleasant, for the sake of the big picture. And that's when we have a conflict. And for the procrastinator, that conflict tends to end a certain way every time, leaving him spending a lot of time in this orange zone, an easy and fun place that's entirely out of the Makes Sense circle. I call it the Dark Playground.

POST LISTENING

1. How did Tim Urban plan to do his thesis? And what was the end results?
2. What hypothesis did the writer-blogger guy have about the brains of procrastinators?
3. What did the writer-blogger guy compare in an MRI lab to test his hypothesis?
4. What is the name of the part of the brain that the writer-blogger guy refers to as the "Rational Decision-Maker"?
5. How does the writer-blogger guy describe the conflict within the brain between the Monkey and the Rational Decision-Maker?
6. According to the writer-blogger guy, where does the procrastinator spend a lot of time?
7. In what kind of times does the Monkey's approach of being well-slept, well-fed, and propagating into the next generation work well?
8. Why does the writer-blogger guy believe that humans have an advantage over other animal species?

POST LISTENING

- 1. He had anticipated completing the task within a 72-hour timeframe; however, his efforts ended in utter failure.**
- 2. The writer-blogger guy hypothesized that the brains of procrastinators were different than the brains of other people.**
- 3. The writer-blogger guy compared his own brain to the brain of a proven non-procrastinator.**
- 4. The Rational Decision-Maker is the name given to the part of the brain that enables humans to visualize the future, see the big picture, and make long-term plans.**

POST LISTENING

- 5. The writer-blogger guy describes the conflict as a struggle between the Monkey, which represents primal instincts and immediate gratification, and the Rational Decision-Maker, which represents long-term planning and considering the big picture.**
- 6. The procrastinator spends a lot of time in the "Dark Playground," which is described as an easy and fun place outside the realm of what makes sense or is productive.**
- 7. The Monkey's approach of being well-slept, well-fed, and propagating into the next generation worked well in tribal times.**
- 8. The writer-blogger guy believes that humans have an advantage over other animal species because they have the Rational Decision-Maker, which allows them to visualize the future, see the big picture, and make long-term plans.**

THANK YOU

Reference:

https://www.ted.com/talks/tim_urban_inside_the_mind_of_a_master_procrastinator